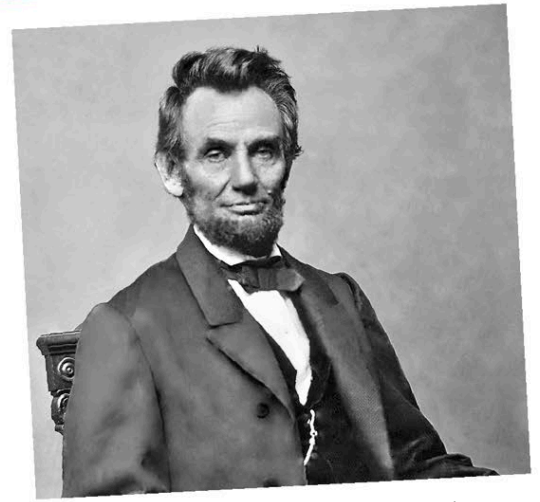


The Civil War

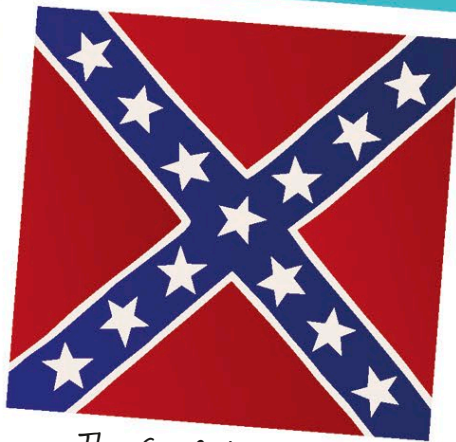
In 1861, a war broke out in the United States that split the country in two. Eleven states feared that the government would free African-American slaves, workers who were owned by other people and not paid. These states left, or seceded from, the United States to form the Confederacy. The states that remained loyal to the United States were known as the Union. The two sides fought for four years.



Abraham Lincoln in 1860

The Confederate flag

When the 11 Southern states left the Union and set up the Confederacy, they created their own flag. The 13 stars stood for the Confederate states and the states that supported them.



The Confederate flag

KEY (1861)



Union states
Twenty-three states remained in the Union.



Confederate states
Eleven slave-owning states left the Union to join the Confederacy.



Slave-owning Union states
Some states stayed in the Union but allowed slavery.



Other territories
These territories did not get involved in the war.



Cotton fields
Slaves grew cotton on plantations in the South.



Union ships
These blocked other ships from getting into and out of the South. This made it hard to buy and sell things in the Confederacy.



Conflicts
Places where the Union and Confederate armies fought.

KANSAS

MISSOURI

OKLAHOMA

ARKANSAS

MISSISSIPPI

TEXAS

LOUISIANA

GULF OF MEXICO



SCALE

0 250 miles
0 250 kilometers

Divided country

The Civil War was fought between the Southern Confederate and the Northern Union states of the United States.



President Lincoln

Abraham Lincoln was elected president of the United States in November 1860. He spoke out against slavery, causing 11 southern states to leave the Union. Lincoln led the Union to victory in 1865.

After a long battle, the Confederate fort of Vicksburg surrendered on July 4, 1863. Its surrender cut the Confederacy in two.



Siege of Vicksburg